

Texas G.O.P.
Calls for Unity
After a Battle

Hoping Paxton's Victory
Won't Flip State Blue

By J. DAVID GOODMAN
and LAUREN MCGAUGHY

Republicans in Texas began uniting behind a slate of hard-line candidates elected on Tuesday, looking beyond their bruising and protracted primaries and toward a November showdown against newly energized Democrats.

They did so with President Trump's hand firmly on the controls of the party in the nation's most powerful conservative state.

Ken Paxton's resounding victory in the Republican runoff for U.S. Senate solidified Mr. Trump's iron grip. And candidates backed by Mr. Trump also won in U.S. House primaries around Houston and San Antonio, where the president's influence was pitted against that of state leaders, including Gov. Greg Abbott.

In choosing Mr. Paxton, and several other MAGA-aligned candidates, Republican primary voters in Texas made a familiar bet: that the state is conservative enough that any Republican, even the most conservative, can beat a Democrat in the fall, and keep the state red.

For some Republican consultants, Tuesday's results demonstrated the increasing power of the Trump-aligned, far right of the party, which has long battled the party's institutionalists in Texas.

"The activist wing of the party flexes its muscles in the face of the establishment," Anthony Holm, a former consultant for Mr. Paxton, said in an interview at Mr. Paxton's election night watch party. He believed the party would come together quickly, "because the alternative is James Talarico," Mr. Holm said, referring to the Democratic nominee for Senate.

For those like Senator John Cornyn, who was defeated by Mr. Paxton, the only choice now was to line up behind the ticket.

Democrats in Texas had hoped that the fractures would remain beyond the primary. But almost as soon as Mr. Cornyn conceded the race to Mr. Paxton, the state's attorney general, Republicans urged each other to come together. "Governor Abbott calls for unity after Republican runoff elections," read an email sent by the governor's campaign Tuesday evening.

"A united Republican Party will drive victory," Mr. Abbott said in the accompanying statement.

Not known as a uniter, Mr. Paxton also jumped into the role immediately on Tuesday, thanking

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Crews at the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool last week. The Park Service accepted the no-bid contract, reasoning the difficult job and tight deadline justified the cost.

Giuliani's Son
Fills Big Chair
At World Cup

By MATT FLEGENHEIMER
and REBECCA R. RUIZ

Andrew Giuliani was haggling in a Florida hospital room, defending his presence to his recently comatose father — a man so stricken a short time earlier that a priest had been called.

At least Dad sounded like himself again.

"What are you doing here?" former Mayor Rudolph W. Giuliani asked after waking earlier this month, according to Andrew Giuliani, who had scrambled south from Washington, where he holds a senior federal post conferred by a president whom he has described as a second father figure. "You've got to get your ass back up to D.C."

Five weeks remained before the highest-stakes professional moment of Andrew Giuliani's zigzagging, sometimes painful, increasingly consequential public life.

And President Trump had made his own expectations clear.

"You better do well, Andrew," he said for the cameras last year, after making Mr. Giuliani the top-ranking administration official who once smiled at the boss through baby teeth.

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In Cuba, Cooking Over a Sooty Fire 18 Floors Up

By ED AUGUSTIN and
LISETTE POOLE GONZÁLEZ

SANTIAGO DE CUBA, Cuba — On a recent night, Yusimi Castellano crouched over her squat iron stove, arranging charcoal and gently placing the Styrofoam and the plastic she used as kindling over it. She used a cigarette lighter to start a small fire.

Noxious smoke billowed through her 18th-floor apartment, eventually sweeping out toward the former military barracks where the Cuban Revolution is said to have begun and the verdant mountains that wrap around Santiago de Cuba, the country's second-largest city.

Slowly, the charcoal began to glow. She put a grill made of old coat hangers on top and boiled

some spaghetti for her family's dinner.

"I shouldn't be cooking with charcoal," said Ms. Castellano, 58, who has asthma and lately has been short of breath and coughing constantly. "But if I don't cook, I die."

Ms. Castellano's crude cooking methods have become the norm across the complex of five 18-story buildings, each with 120 apartments, where she lives and that were meant to showcase the revolution's promise when they

opened four decades ago.

Today, some people can't even afford charcoal and resort to chopping firewood to cook in their homes.

Life here and across much of Cuba, already difficult because of an economy that has been a shambles for years, has become even worse since the Trump administration mounted its escalating pressure campaign against the country's Communist government.

First, the administration stopped oil deliveries from Venezuela, Cuba's main benefactor, after U.S. forces in January captured Venezuela's president.

Then President Trump used the threat of tariffs to cut off foreign fuel shipments almost entirely, in-

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The elevators rarely work at an apartment complex in Santiago de Cuba built to be a showcase.

PROFIT 'INFLATED'
FOR POOL PROJECT

U.S. Analysis Faults Cost to Fix D.C. Landmark

By DAVID A. FAHRENTHOLD

WASHINGTON — A National Park Service analysis found that the contractor given a no-bid contract to repair the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool is being paid an inflated and excessive profit margin, according to federal documents obtained by The New York Times.

That analysis, prepared by a Park Service contracting specialist, found that the typical profit margin of federal construction contracts like this one is 6 percent to 12 percent. But the firm fixing the Reflecting Pool, Virginia-based Atlantic Industrial Coatings, submitted a bid that charged 20 percent, adding at least \$850,000 to what a more typical contract would have cost.

The Park Service accepted that bid after a contracting official reasoned that the company deserved it for accepting a difficult job on a tight deadline. The government eventually agreed to pay the firm \$13.1 million, which is seven times the amount that President Trump initially said the work would cost.

Now that the repair work is underway, however, other documents indicate that the same contractor had — at least initially — not been able to perform one of the most critical parts of its repair job: sealing the gaps between the concrete slabs at the pool's floor.

Water has leaked out of those gaps for decades, creating a costly problem that President Trump has vowed to fix. But the contractor's attempts to seal those gaps failed in two trials earlier this month, forcing the company and the Park Service to brainstorm

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‘A whole civilization
will die tonight, never to be
brought back again.’
Truth Social post on April 7

‘We have had very,
very strong talks ...’
Press gaggle on March 23

‘They are “begging,”
us to make a deal ...’
Truth Social post on March 26

The War in Iran,
According to Trump

He has tried threats, and made unfounded claims of progress.
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In Discordant Times, Kennedy Center Falls Into a Jarring Silence

By MICHAELA TOWFIGHI

WASHINGTON — The John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts felt like a school shuttered for summer vacation.

When David Jones recently arrived for the first time in months, there were new metal detectors in the lobby but hardly anybody for the security guards to wave through. He hoped to pick up new sheet music, but the building's librarian was not there. Neither were most of the faces he used to see daily. Outside, the large banners that typically promoted new shows had come down.

Jones, 60, has been the principal clarinetist of the Kennedy Center Opera House Orchestra since 1998. From its perch beneath the stage, the group anchors performances for the Washington National Opera and ballet and theater productions at the treasured cultural institution.

But this year, Jones has rarely set foot in the building.

President Trump's takeover of

Veteran Musician Feels
‘Punched in the Chest’

the traditionally nonpartisan center kept many of the groups Jones was scheduled to perform with away from Washington. The creative team behind “Hamilton” was among the first to protest. After Trump's name was added to the building's facade, the San Francisco and New York City ballets

followed suit. The Washington National Opera decided to pack up and leave its longtime home.

The cascading cancellations were devastating for the orchestra and its 61 professional musicians. Their annual salary is paid by performance, and the lack of work has been demoralizing. The whole ensemble last played together in the Kennedy Center with the American Ballet Theater in February.

And the future is even bleaker:

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Over 70 employees have been suspended or fired over allegations of sexual abuse and other misconduct, and one is on trial. PAGE A4

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The country has a time zone a quarter of an hour apart from its neighbors. (It also has some 32-day months.) PAGE A5

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Donald E. Newhouse, 96, ran the lucrative and prize-winning newspaper division of Advance Publications. PAGE B10

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The United Nations has a new plan for weighing economic gains alongside health and environmental progress. But consensus is elusive. PAGE B1

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A journalist whose segment on migrants was recently pulled said CBS News let her contract expire. PAGE B1

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Karyl Pickens, a pitcher at Tennessee, is on the verge of throwing 80 m.p.h., a once-unthinkable milestone. PAGE B6

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“I didn't come from money,” Nabela Noor says on her idealized take on life as a daughter of immigrants. PAGE D1

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Maurice Kamara gets strangers to talk about what they're wearing. Even those who couldn't be bothered. PAGE D4



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Alden Ehrenreich brings laughs and tears as a money manager in the Broadway show “Becky Shaw.” PAGE C1

‘Yogurt Shop Murders’ Twist
That the culprit was never suspected on the HBO documentary wasn't the point. The agony of uncertainty was. PAGE C1

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Jack Herrera PAGE A18

